Evaluating the Career Achievements of Corbin Carroll

If he plays for Chinese Taipei in the WBC, how much help would he provide?

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Image Source: https://calltothepen.com/2023/01/28/arizona-

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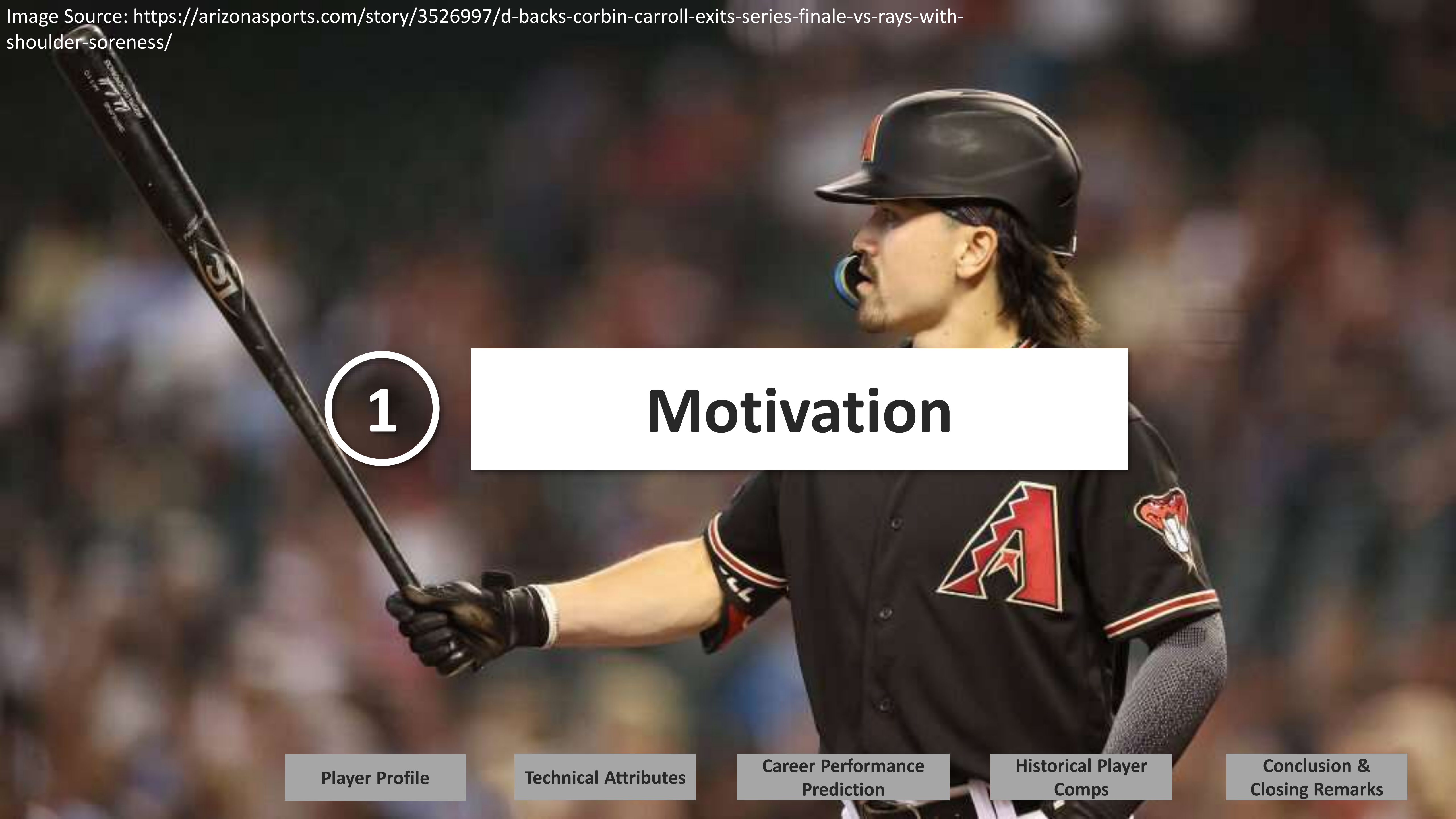

Image Source: https://arizonasports.com/story/3526997/d-backs-corbin-carroll-exits-series-finale-vs-rays-with-shoulder-soreness/

1

Motivation

Player Profile | Technical Attributes | Career Performance Prediction | Historical Player Comps | Conclusion & Closing Remarks

Motivation

Taiwanese-American represents Chinese-Taipei(Taiwan)？	MLB NL Rookie of Year？	Next Superstar of Team Chinese Taipei？
Due to flexible citizenship rules in the World Baseball Classic (WBC), MLB top prospect and Taiwanese-American player Corbin Carroll drew significant attention over his potential eligibility to represent Chinese Taipei.	This season, Corbin Carroll shone brightly in MLB, earning an All-Star selection in his rookie year while emerging as a top contender for NL Rookie of the Year and entering NL MVP discussions.	If Corbin Carroll represents Chinese Taipei in the next WBC, what element of player would Chinese Taipei be getting?

Motivated by this, the following analysis examines Corbin Carroll's technical attributes and projects his future career, aiming to introduce this Taiwanese-American player to baseball fans in Taiwan.

(Note: All data cutoff prior to the 2023 MLB All-Star Break)

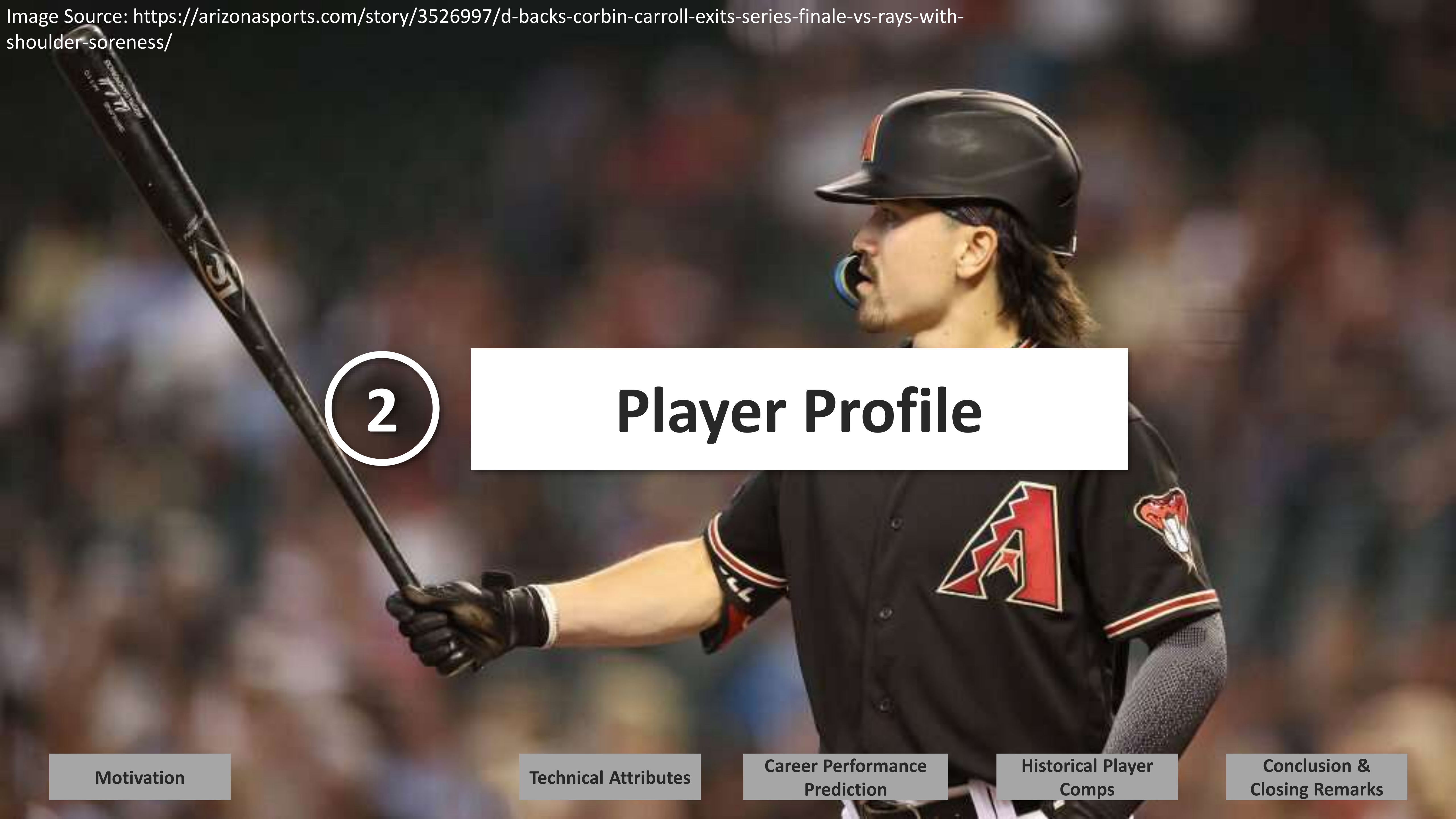

Image Source: https://arizonasports.com/story/3526997/d-backs-corbin-carroll-exits-series-finale-vs-rays-with-shoulder-soreness/

2 Player Profile

Player Profile

Born on Aug 21, 2000 in Seattle. Father Brant Carroll is American; Mother Pei-Lin Carroll was born in Taiwan and immigrated to the US at age 6.

2019

Selected by the Diamondbacks with the 16th overall pick in the first round, with a signing bonus of $3.74 million.

2021

Sidelined for the remainder of the season due to a shoulder injury after making seven appearances at High-A.

2022

Started at Double-A and made his Major League debut in late August.

2023

Before the season began, he reached an agreement with the team on an eight-year, $111 million contract extension, becoming the first player to sign a deal worth over $100 million with less than 100 days of service time. As a rookie, he was selected as a starting outfielder for the Major League Baseball All-Star Game.

Image Source: https://arizonasports.com/story/3526997/d-backs-corbin-carroll-exits-series-finale-vs-rays-with-shoulder-soreness/

3 Technical Attributes

3 Technical Attributes

Baserunning	Batted Ball Profile	Plate Discipline	Pitch Type Breakdown	Pitch Zone Heatmaps	Fielding & Defense

Image Source:
https://www.baseballprospectus.com/fantasy/article/78898/fantasy-

1. Baserunning

Baserunning

6th in MLB

According to Statcast, Corbin Carroll's Sprint Speed reaches 30.1 ft/s this season, ranking 6th in MLB.

Smart Application of Speed Talent

Statcast records 87 baserunning advance opportunities. He ran on 47 (54% rate, 16% above 38% Statcast expected rate) with only 1 failure (98% success rate).

He does not run recklessly. He reads game situations accurately while utilizing his elite speed to advance baserunners.

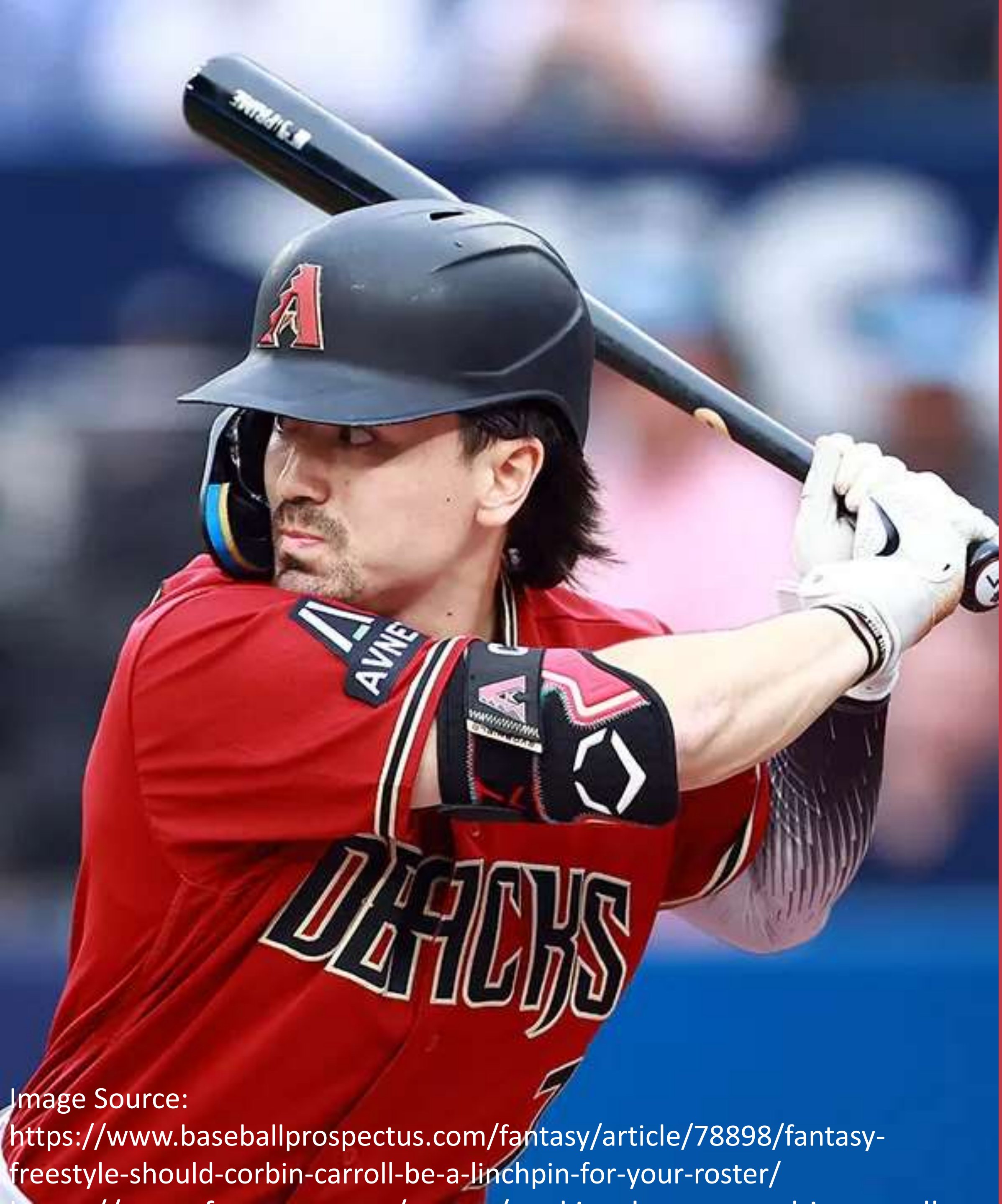

Image Source:
https://www.baseballprospectus.com/fantasy/article/78898/fantasy-freestyle-should-corbin-carroll-be-a-linchpin-for-your-roster/

2. Batted Ball Profile

Batted Ball Profile

Let's first look at the traditional statistics and overall attacking performance...

AVG	H	HR	RBI	SB
0.285	89	18	48	26

SLG	OPS	BABIP	wOBA	WRC+
0.549	0.915	0.313	0.383	149

Outstanding surface stats earned him All-Star honors and Rookie of the Year contention; however, inspecting advanced Statcast metrics reveals:

Batted Ball Profile

Metric	Stat	Notes
Barrel%	8.6%	Beats 54% of MLB
Hard Hit%	41.6%	Beats 56% of MLB
Sweet Spot%	30%	
EV (Exit Velocity)	90.6mph	Beats 69% of MLB
Max EV	113.8mph	Beats 91% of MLB
LA (Launch Angle)	11.3	
GB% (Groundball Rate)	47.1%	MLB Avg: 44.7%
FB% (Flyball Rate)	25.3%	MLB Avg: 23.3%
LD% (Line Drive Rate)	22.1%	MLB Avg: 24.9%
K%	19.9%	Beats 64% of MLB
BB%	8.7%	Beats 53% of MLB
wOBA	0.383	Beats 94% of MLB
xwOBA	0.344	Beats 70% of MLB

(Note: Source: Statcast)

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Did not live up to the stats

Although both Barrel% and Hard Hit% are above league average, they are not quite as outstanding as the overall offensive performance suggests.

The attack is not highly effective

Although his launch angle resembles that of a typical medium-power hitter, his rate of line drives, the most productive of the three batted-ball types (ground balls, fly balls, and line drives), is the lowest among the three and the only one falling below the MLB average; this lack of offensive efficiency is also reflected in his unimpressive Barrel%.

Explosive power when hitting

Despite lacking a high volume of elite-quality contact and not possessing a large frame, he can still generate a maximum exit velocity of 113.8 mph, surpassing 91% of MLB players, and his average exit velocity also beats nearly 70% of the league, indicating that whenever he squares the ball up, the result is generally positive.

Batted Ball Profile

Given that actual batting performance has not been as strong as the raw stats suggest, with wOBA significantly higher than xwOBA, the results appear somewhat inflated and could face a downward adjustment; however, we believe the extent of this correction will be minimal, primarily because:

Luck Factor is Minimal

His BABIP (Batting Average on Balls In Play) is .313, which is not far off from his batting average of .285; there aren't many "cheap hits" involved, so while his stats might be slightly inflated, the extent of that inflation isn't as great as outsiders imagine.

Elite Speed Boosts Infield Hits

His sprint speed converts weak grounders into infield hits and takes extra bases, causing expected metrics like xwOBA to underestimate his true value.

Image Source: https://www.fantraxhq.com/fantrax-injury-report-corbin-carrolls-shoulder-woes-return/

3. Plate Discipline

Plate Discipline

As the table below shows, his contact rate is an impressive 80.7% (surpassing 75% of Major League players), indicating that he rarely swings and misses and possesses the ability to battle effectively at the plate.

(MLB Average)	**Swing%**	**Contact%**
In-Zone (Z-Zone)	67.1%(68.5%)	86.6%(85.5%)
Out-Zone (O-Zone)	29.8%(31.7%)	71.4%(62.4%)
Total	45.1%(47.1%)	80.7%(71.4%)

Plate Discipline

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Total	45.1%(47.1%)	80.7%(71.4%)

High Contact Rate

His high overall Contact% is boosted by making contact outside the zone; O-Contact% is 9% above MLB average, while Z-Contact% reaches an elite 86.6%.

Disciplined Swing Frequency

He is not an overly aggressive hitter. Both in-zone and out-of-zone swing frequencies are lower than MLB averages, confirming strong strike zone discipline.

→ Explains his moderate walk rate (chasing out-of-zone strikes) combined with low strikeout rate (high contact & pitch-battling tenacity).

Image Source:

4. Pitch Type Breakdown

Pitch Type Breakdown

According to Statcast, Corbin Carroll's performance against fastballs and offspeed pitches improved significantly over 2022:

Reduced Whiff% led to improvements in AVG, SLG, and xwOBA against fastballs.

Adapting to pitch velocity differences reduced Whiff% and boosted Hard Hit% on offspeed pitches, improving launch angle.

Year	Pitch Type	#	%	PA	AB	H	1B	2B	3B	HR	SO	BBE	BA	XBA	SLG	XSLG	WOBA	XWOBA	EV	LA	Whiff%	PutAway%
2023	Fastballs	805	54.7	197	165	53	27	12	0	14	37	131	.321	.293	.648	.558	.451	.411	88.5	12	17.4	18.6
2023	Breaking	485	33.0	129	118	28	17	5	2	4	29	90	.237	.206	.415	.321	.306	.266	89.0	14	26.3	22.0
2023	Offspeed	181	12.3	57	55	14	7	3	2	2	11	44	.255	.262	.491	.385	.325	.293	88.0	2	23.9	22.0
2022	Fastballs	261	57.0	59	50	10	4	3	1	2	21	29	.200	.175	.420	.327	.328	.287	89.5	10	29.7	35.6
2022	Breaking	151	33.0	40	38	13	6	4	1	2	7	31	.342	.309	.658	.414	.438	.335	86.1	15	24.6	11.9
2022	Offspeed	46	10.0	16	16	4	2	2	0	0	3	13	.250	.155	.375	.329	.268	.206	76.8	-6	36.4	20.0

Pitch Type Breakdown

Examining pitch-by-pitch breakdown in detail reveals:

Year	Pitch Type	Team	RV/100	Run Value	Pitches	%	PA	BA	SLG	wOBA	Whiff%	K%	PutAway %	xBA	xSLG	xwOBA	Hard Hit %
2023	4-Seamer		3.1	14	459	31.4	110	.352	.736	.503	18.4	20.9	18.4	.301	.610	.434	40.0
2023	Slider		0.6	1	261	17.8	65	.220	.424	.311	28.0	20.0	19.7	.189	.303	.267	44.7
2023	Sinker		4.1	9	215	14.7	54	.386	.795	.550	11.3	14.8	15.7	.337	.616	.458	61.1
2023	Curveball		-0.1	0	157	10.7	44	.214	.262	.252	27.5	27.3	25.5	.203	.267	.226	40.0
2023	Changeup		-0.9	-1	144	9.8	43	.244	.463	.324	23.0	11.6	14.7	.250	.361	.283	27.8
2023	Cutter		-1.5	-2	127	8.7	31	.138	.172	.173	22.6	19.4	26.1	.205	.318	.253	30.4
2023	Sweeper		1.1	1	54	3.7	15	.333	.667	.477	15.0	26.7	28.6	.220	.400	.354	37.5
2023	Splitter		-2.4	-1	30	2.1	11	.273	.364	.277	25.0	36.4	30.8	.306	.403	.310	57.1
2023	Slurve		-2.5	0	9	0.6	3	.333	.333	.300	0.0	0.0	0.0	.463	.641	.471	33.3
2023	Forkball		-0.2	0	5	0.3	1	.000	.000	.000	100.0	100.0	100.0	--	--	.000	--
2023	Screwball		42.7	1	2	0.1	2	.500	2.000	1.000	0.0	50.0	50.0	.386	.946	.556	100.0
2022	4-Seamer		-0.4	-1	138	30.1	30	.200	.560	.375	32.8	36.7	31.4	.179	.401	.320	42.9
2022	Slider		6.6	5	81	17.7	23	.381	.905	.546	25.0	26.1	16.7	.270	.400	.325	33.3
2022	Sinker		-1.5	-1	74	16.2	18	.200	.267	.336	21.4	33.3	42.9	.091	.108	.189	33.3
2022	Curveball		-1.1	-1	66	14.4	17	.294	.353	.285	18.5	5.9	4.3	.357	.431	.348	31.3
2022	Cutter		-1.8	-1	49	10.7	11	.200	.300	.259	31.0	36.4	40.0	.290	.468	.360	66.7
2022	Changeup		-0.5	0	32	7.0	11	.273	.364	.277	46.7	27.3	33.3	.095	.113	.089	0.0
2022	Splitter		-5.6	-1	12	2.6	4	.000	.000	.000	16.7	0.0	0.0	.132	.142	.127	0.0
2022	Sweeper		-3.2	0	4	0.9		--	--	--	100.0	--	--	--	--	--	--

! Note: Years are in reverse order.

Pitch Type Breakdown

4-Seam & 2-Seam Fastballs

Unlike last year's struggles, 4-seam and 2-seam fastballs have turned into his primary offensive weapons this season.

Slider

Slider performance normalized after last year's lucky results; despite lower AVG, contact is harder with fewer strikeouts.

Changeup

Changeup/Splitter improved markedly, though contact quality still lags fastballs, leaving room to adapt to velocity differential.

Curveball

Curveball performance dropped significantly from last year, becoming his most strikeout-prone pitch.

Cutter

Performance against cutters remains weak across both seasons.

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Pitch Type Breakdown

Potential reasons and strategies behind pitch type performance gaps:

Adapting to MLB Fastball Velocity

Adapting to MLB Fastball Velocity: Minor leagues feature fewer high-velocity precision pitchers; adjusting to MLB fastballs is a common rookie progression step.

Increasing Hard Contact Quality

Increasing Hard Contact Quality: Hard Hit% improved across pitch types. Surface drops against breaking balls will bounce back as adjustments take hold long term.

Larger Sample Size Reduces Noise

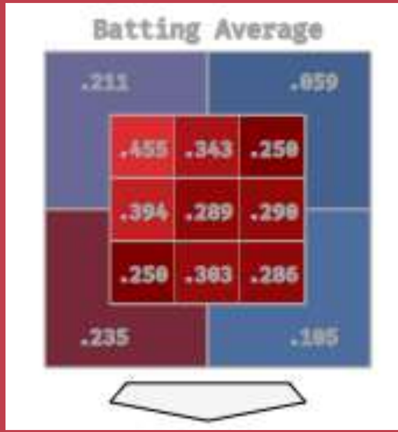
Larger Sample Size Reduces Noise: As plate appearances accumulate, true pitch-hitting capabilities stabilize.

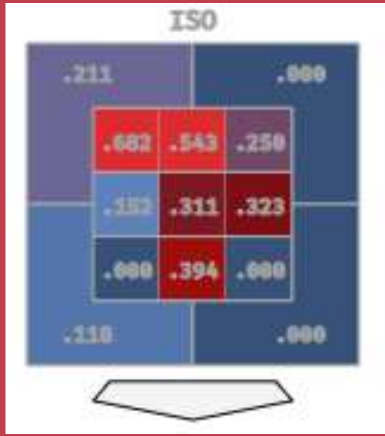
Image Source: https://tw.sports.yahoo.com/news/mlb-%E5%A4%A7%E8%81%AF%E7%9B%9F-%E7%BE%8E%E8%81%B7-%E6%96%B0%E7%A7%80%E5%A0%B1%E5%91%8A-

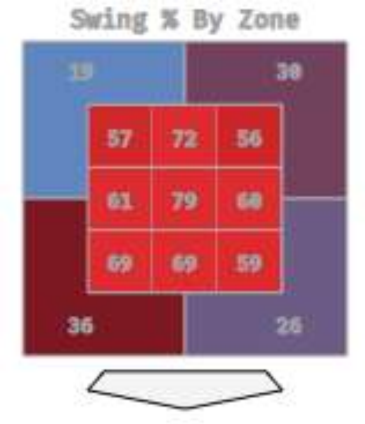
5. Pitch Zone Heatmaps

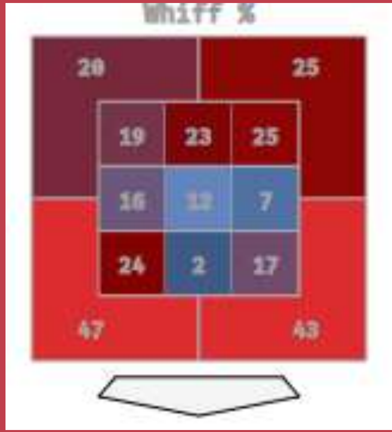
Pitch Zone Heatmaps

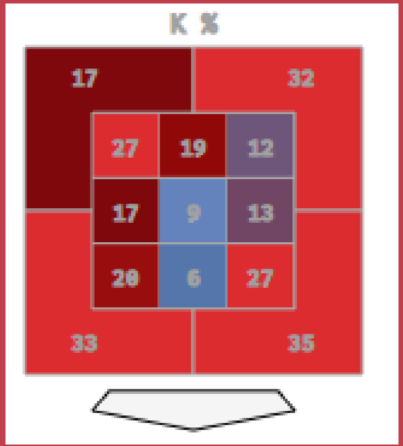
Analyzing pitch location heatmaps reveals key hitting traits:

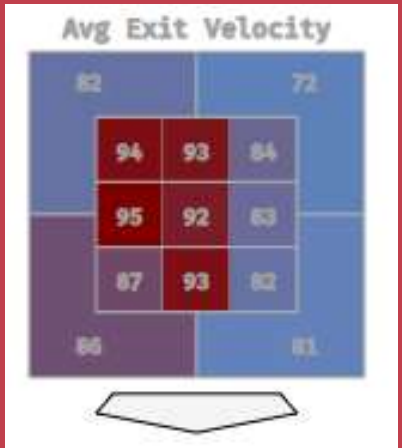


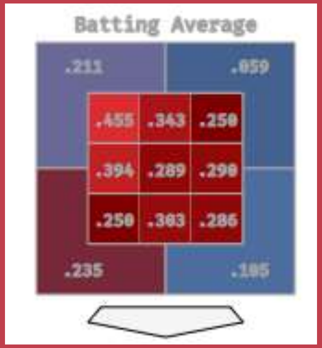


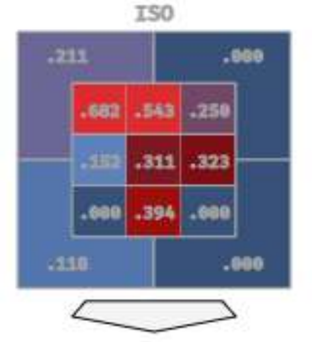


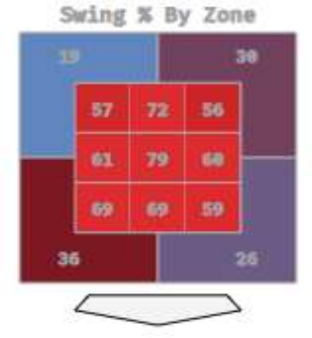


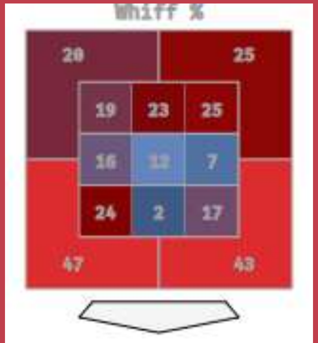


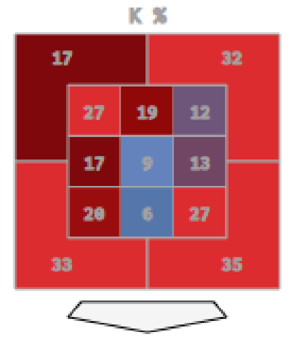


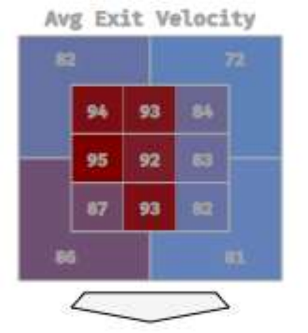












Pitch Zone Heatmaps

- Zones 1 & 2 represent his primary danger zones; high-and-outside locations yield maximum offensive power.

- Demonstrates both power and plate discipline high-and-outside, filtering out balls above the zone.

- Weaker against inside and low pitches. While high-inside pitches draw chases, he still makes contact; however, low-zone pitches generate >40% Whiff%, causing most strikeouts.

- Pitches in Zones 2 & 3 produce extra-base hits; high-outside pitches yield line drives/grounders; low-outside pitches turn into weak groundouts.

Pitch Type vs. Pitch Zone

Performance across hitting zones strongly correlates with pitch types faced:

Zones 1-3: 4-Seam & 2-Seam Fastballs

High fastballs are heavily used in modern MLB; Carroll's dominance high in the zone mirrors his elite fastball results.

Zones 7 & 9: Sliders & Curveballs

High Whiff% low in the zone aligns with his breaking ball vulnerability, consistent with MLB pitching strategy.

Zone 7: Changeups

High Whiff% and negative launch angle in Zone 7 match offspeed outcomes, indicating pitchers target this location with changeups.

Note: Although his performance against different pitch types is correlated with his performance in different hitting zones, this does not imply a causal relationship between the two factors.

Summary of Hitting Profile

Mastery of High Pitches	Vulnerable to Low Breaking Balls	Moderate Line Drive Rate	Solid Contact & Speed Floor
Mastery of High Pitches: Excellent control high in the zone. Fastballs high-outside or middle-in will be punished heavily.	Vulnerable to Low Breaking Balls: Low breaking pitches induce whiffs; discipline and contact quality low in the zone need improvement.	Moderate Line Drive Rate: Though strong high-inside, launch angle generates grounders over line drives, keeping Barrel% moderate.	Due to a combination of solid contact ability, excellent explosive power at the plate, and league-leading speed, even if future performance metrics regress, the drop-off from current levels won't be drastic.

Image Source: https://udn.com/news/story/122629/7212422

6. Fielding & Defense

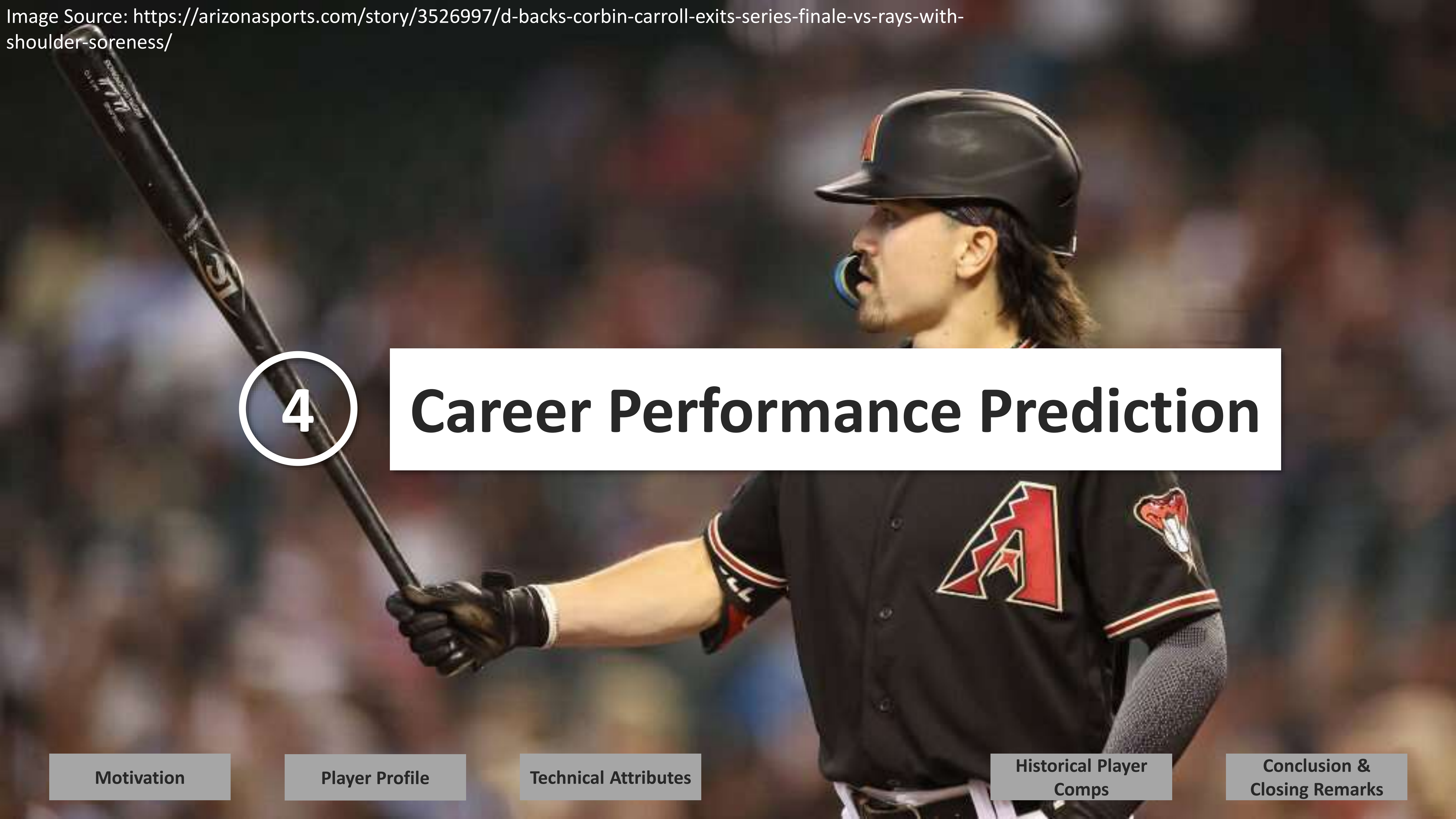
Fielding & Defense

- Elite Speed Advantage: Exceptional sprint speed provides wide defensive range, reflected in 3 OAA (beats 87% of MLB).
- His Catch Probability exceeds expected by 2%; refining route jumps will further enhance his defensive value.
- Below-Average Arm Strength (beats only 39% of MLB) limits overall defensive upside:
  - Center field (demanding arm strength) yields 0 OAA, whereas Right Field is 1 OAA and Left Field is 2 OAA.
  - His runner advancement hold rate (61%) trails expected rate by 4%; once runners advance, success rate reaches 99%.

Fielding & Defense

Possesses the range to be a solid defender, but arm strength limits elite status. Transitioning to left field may maximize overall value long term.

Image Source: https://arizonasports.com/story/3526997/d-backs-corbin-carroll-exits-series-finale-vs-rays-with-shoulder-soreness/



4 Career Performance Prediction

Preface: Scouting Reports

In scouting reports, Corbin Carroll's initial archetype comp was Andrew Benintendi. However, our evaluation shows:

Similarities

Undersized frame, strong contact ability, high GB% with low LD%, solid tools (though Benintendi failed to fully translate speed/defense to MLB).

Differences

Carroll boasts superior raw exit velocity, max EV, and Hard Hit%, yielding far higher slugging upside. Paired with elite speed and defense, surpassing Benintendi is only a matter of time.

We combine his MLB performance with historical data to project Carroll's career trajectory and identify matching player archetypes.

Prediction Methodology

Evaluating Development Templates Across Two Dimensions:

- Dimension 1: Career Achievements & Longevity (Using time series and statistical models to project active career length and accumulated WAR).

- Dimension 2: Speed, Hitting, and Defensive Profile Comps (Selecting key Statcast metrics and using statistical testing to measure feature similarity).

For detailed forecasting methodology, visit: https://mmoamtoh.wordpress.com/2023/08/03/evaluating-the-career-achievements-corbin-carroll/

1. Estimating Career Achievements

Estimating Career Achievements

Estimation Target: Total Career Wins Above Replacement (WAR).
Models: XGBoost time-series regression paired with Locally Adaptive Conformal Prediction (LACP) for non-parametric uncertainty guarantees.
Data Source: FanGraphs

Estimating Career Achievements

Estimation Target: Total Career Wins Above Replacement (WAR).

1. Forecasting Active Career Longevity

1. Extract historical career stats for retired MLB hitters.
2. Set active career length (seasons) as response variable and numerical stats as independent variables.
3. Partition player-level data: 80% Training, 10% Calibration, 10% Testing.
4. Forecast Corbin Carroll's active career length.
5. Repeat steps 3 & 4 over 100 iterations and average results.

Estimating Career Achievements

Estimation Target: Total Career Wins Above Replacement (WAR).

2. Forecasting Career WAR Output

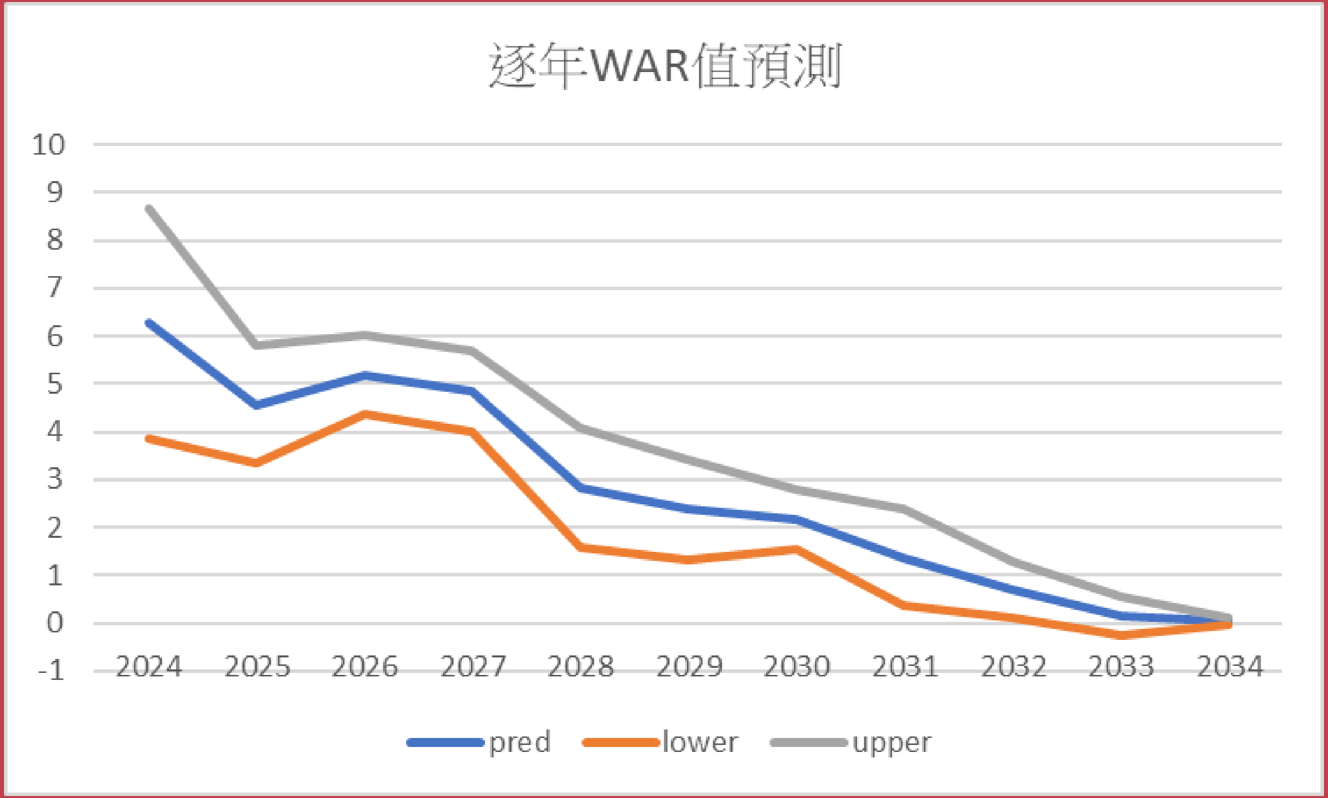
1. Extract seasonal hitting statistics for all MLB batters.
2. Exclude incomplete historical records (mainly pre-modern era).
3. Use current age and prior-year WAR as independent variables to predict current-year WAR (time series model).
4. Segment players initially using decision trees.
5. In each subset, sort by career year: 80% Training data, 10% Calibration data, and 10% Test data.
6. 6. Train customized models for each player subset.
7. 7. Obtain Carroll's ZiPS Rest-of-Season projections on FanGraphs, assign to his subset, and use calibration/test data to predict 2024 WAR.
8. 8. Recursively repeat for (N-2) horizons (N = projected career length) and sum seasonal predictions to project total career WAR.

Estimating Career Achievements

- Under a 90% confidence level, Corbin Carroll's active career length is projected at 10–14 years. Under a 99.6% confidence interval, his career WAR ranges between 33.15 and 55.79, with a point estimate of 44.38 WAR over 12 seasons.
- Historical MLB Data: 336 MLB hitters fall within this career WAR interval.

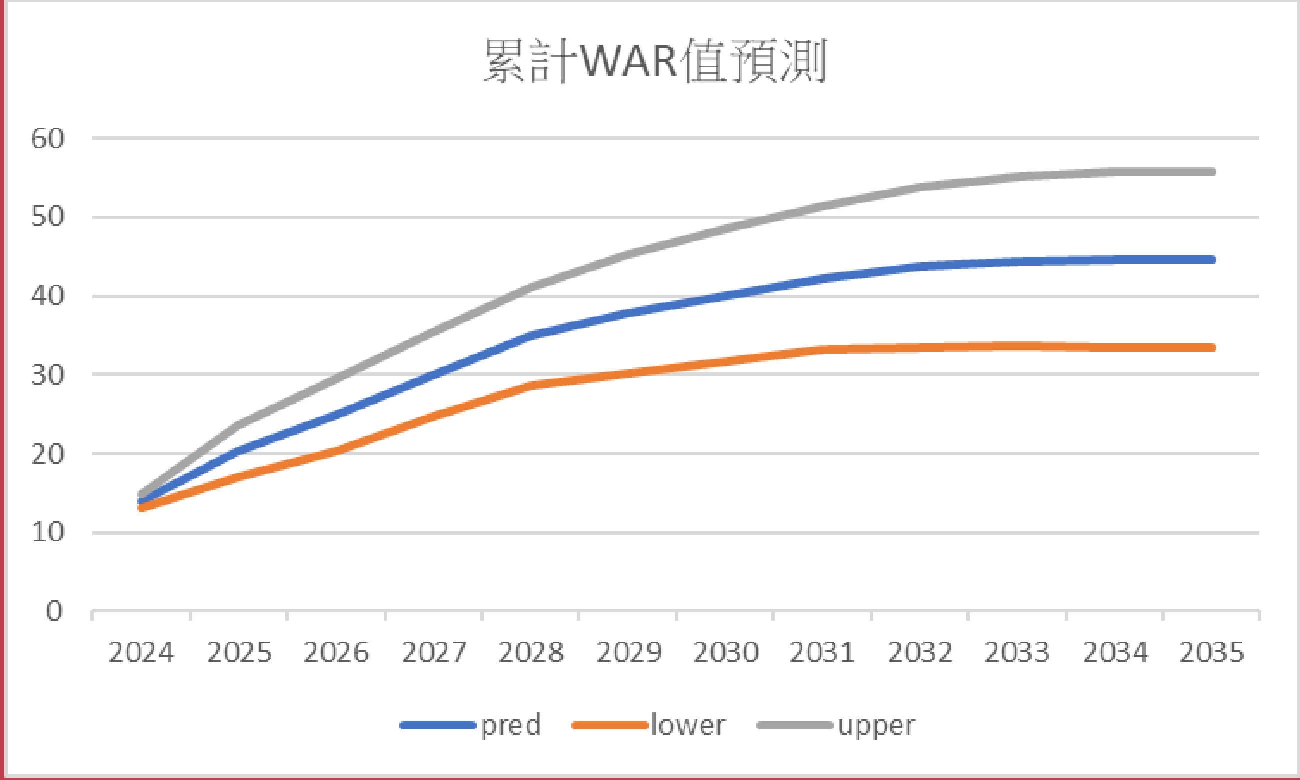
Estimating Career Achievements

The table below shows the projected single-season WAR values for Corbin Carroll over the coming years *(using α = 0.6 for Conformal Prediction)*:



Estimating Career Achievements

The table below shows the projected cumulative WAR for Corbin Carroll over the next few years *(using α=0.6 for conformal prediction)*:



Cumulative Confidence Coverage	
year	CI
2024	40%
2025	64%
2026	78.4%
2027	87.04%
2028	92.22%
2029	95.33%
2030	97.2%
2031	98.32%
2032	98.99%
2033	99.4%
2034	99.64%
2035	99.78%

2. Comparing Speed, Hitting & Defensive Profile

Comparing Speed, Hitting & Defensive Profile

Use the following metrics, combined with the corresponding statistical data, to identify batters with offensive tendencies similar to Corbin Carroll's:

- Swing%/Contact%/O-Contact%
- OAA per inning
- Sprint Speed
- Max exit velocity
- Barrel%

For the sections highlighted in red, a z-test is used to determine whether there is a statistically significant difference between the player's statistics and those of Corbin Carroll. The sections highlighted in yellow show the player's league percentile; the difference between this and Corbin Carroll's percentile is then calculated, with a smaller value indicating that the player's ability in that area is closer to Corbin Carroll's.

Comparing Speed, Hitting & Defensive Profile

Data Extraction & Selection Pipeline:

1. Retrieve data for all Major League batters and exclude players who lack data for all five of the aforementioned metrics.

2. Calculate p-values for Swing%, Contact%, O-Contact%, and Barrel% using a z-test, and compute the average of the p-values for Swing%, Contact%, and O-Contact% (assigning a p-value of 0 if a player lacks data for a specific metric).

3. Calculate the percentile rankings for OAA per inning, Sprint Speed, and Max Exit Velocity, and determine the difference in percentile relative to Corbin Carroll (assigning a value of 0 if data is missing). Note: Since OAA is a cumulative statistic that can be positive or negative, OAA per inning is used for the calculation and percentile comparison.

4. Select players who meet both of the following criteria: the two p-values are greater than 0.0025, and the absolute values of the three percentile differences are all less than 0.37.

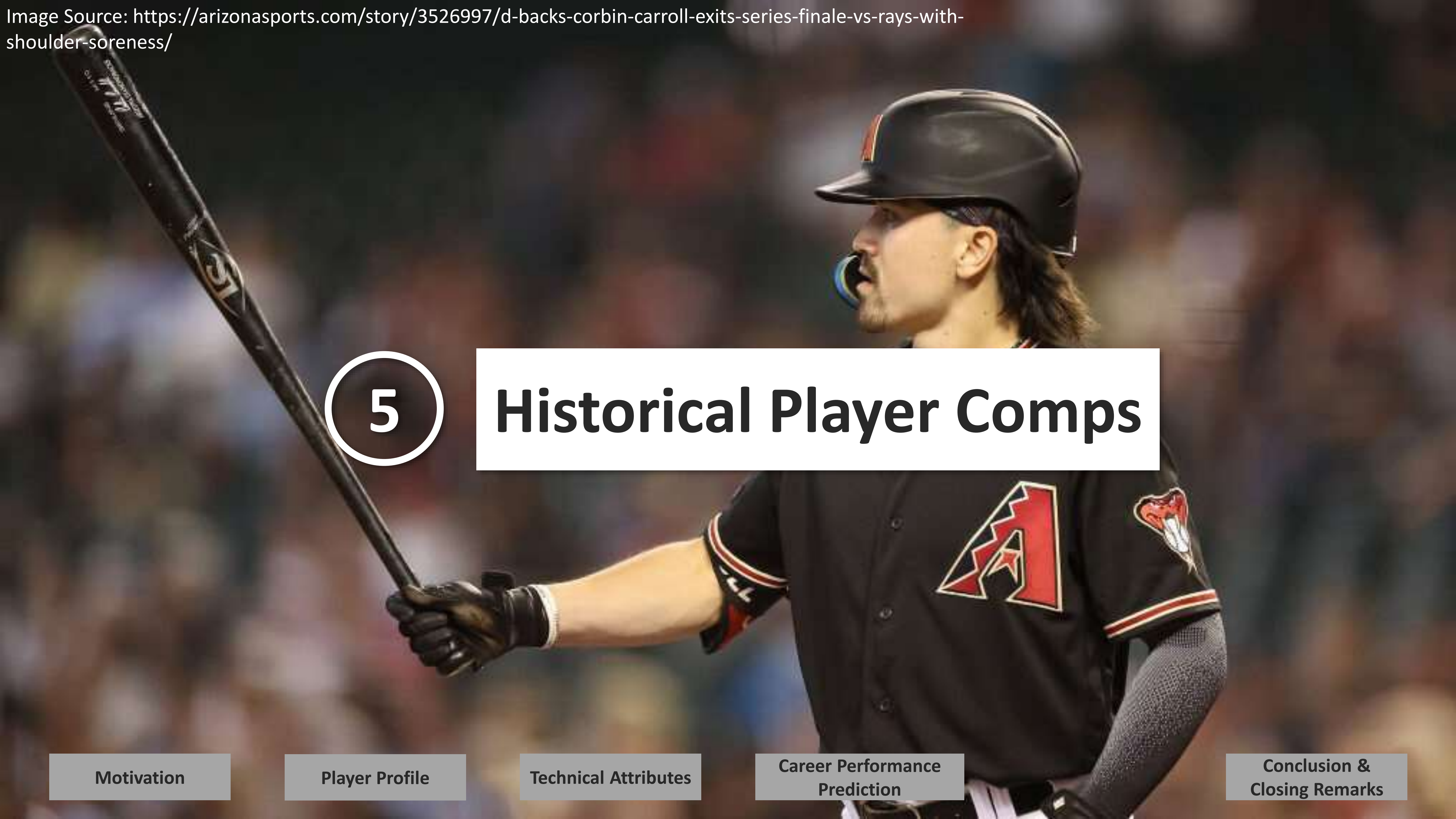
Comparing Speed, Hitting & Defensive Profile

Following the aforementioned screening process, a total of 80 players were identified as having technical attributes similar to those of Corbin Carroll.

If we further filter by projected WAR values (33.15, 55.79), only eight players match Corbin Carroll, six of whom are active. Even if the WAR range is broadened to 30–60, only eleven players fit the criteria.

A likely reason is that Corbin Carroll possesses a high level of ability across the board, hitting, power, speed, and defense, whereas players combining all these attributes were less common in the past.

Image Source: https://arizonasports.com/story/3526997/d-backs-corbin-carroll-exits-series-finale-vs-rays-with-shoulder-soreness/



5 Historical Player Comps

Motivation | Player Profile | Technical Attributes | Career Performance Prediction | Conclusion & Closing Remarks

Historical Player Comps

Based on an in-depth comparison of eight similar players, one player has been selected to represent each of the low, average, and high benchmarks.

Lower-end benchmark: Jason Heyward (WAR: 34.9)

High contact rate, low barrel and hard-hit rates, plus superior explosive power:

- Essentially, Jason Heyward exhibited the same hitting tendencies as Corbin Carroll, only to a more extreme degree.
- Solid defense and baserunning speed.

Historical Player Comps

Based on an in-depth comparison of eight similar players, one player has been selected to represent each of the low, average, and high benchmarks.

Benchmark: Hanley Ramirez (WAR: 41.7)

- High Contact Rate:

But less likely to swing at pitches outside the strike zone

- Similar contact quality:

Barrel rate, launch angle, and line drive rate are very similar; however, superior power and explosiveness give him a slight edge in exit velocity and Hard-Hit rate

- Defensive ability and baserunning speed during his prime:

Top-tier within the league

Historical Player Comps

Based on an in-depth comparison of eight similar players, one player has been selected to represent each of the low, average, and high benchmarks.

Benchmark: Francisco Lindor (WAR: 45.2)

- Potential to surpass 60 WAR:

Given his current MLB performance, he has a strong chance of exceeding the 60-WAR mark in the future.

- More aggressive and tenacious at the plate:

Both his Swing% and Contact% are 2–4% higher than Carroll's; while walk rates are similar, Lindor's career strikeout rate (15.9%) is significantly lower than Carroll's (22%).

- Line-drive-oriented hitting profile:

Because he primarily hits line drives, his Barrel% isn't exceptional; however, while his exit velocity and solid-contact rate aren't elite, they are still somewhat better than Carroll's.

- Superior defense and solid speed:

A two-time Gold Glove winner who averages over 15 stolen bases per season.

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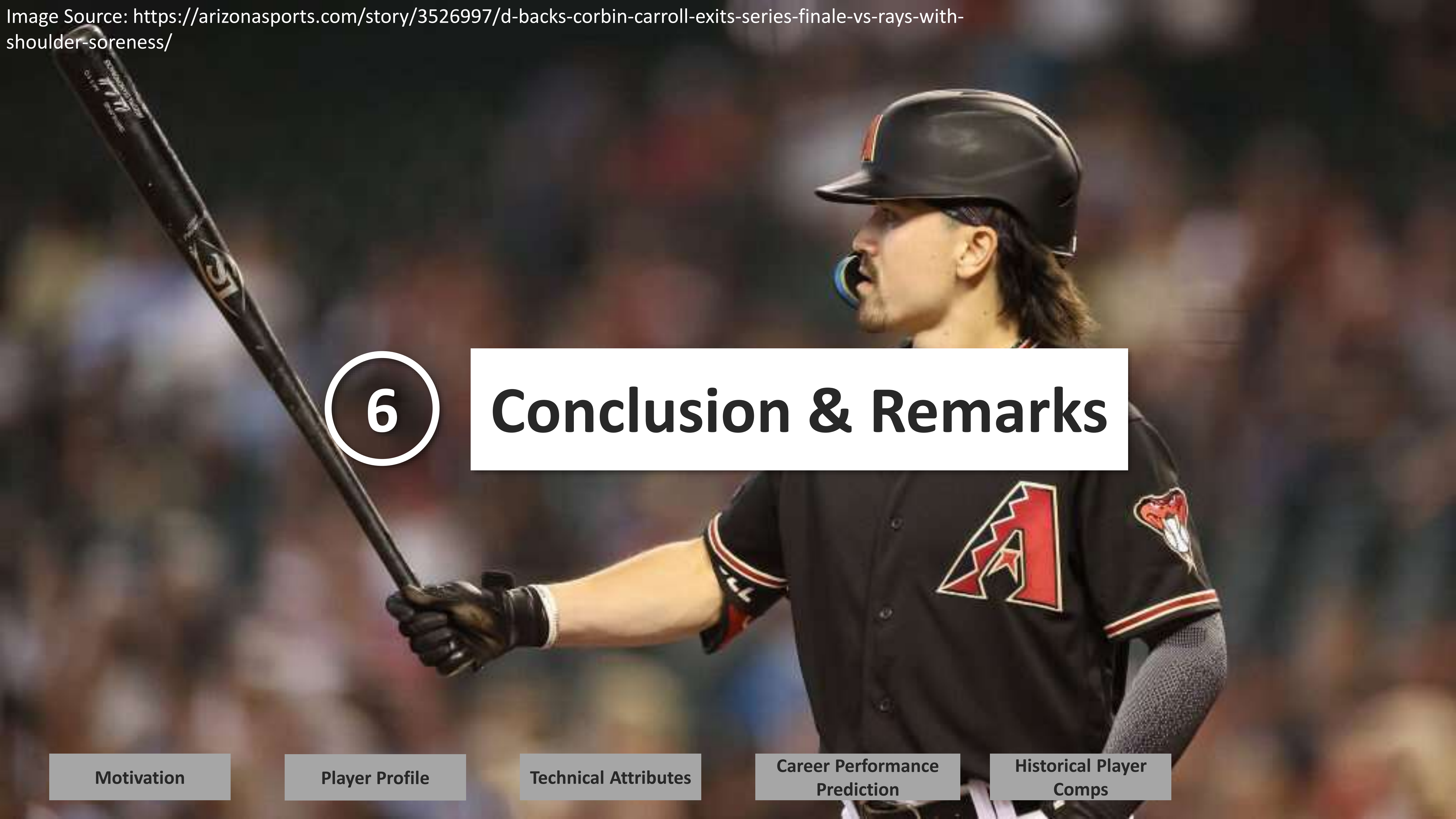

6 Conclusion & Remarks

Conclusion

If he plays for Chinese Taipei in the WBC, how much help would he provide?

Conclusion

What caliber of players does Team Chinese Taipei have? We can glean some clues from the following points:

No position player in Taiwan possesses offensive and defensive capabilities that come anywhere close to Corbin Carroll's level, they can't even see his taillights.

Looking across all of Asia, the only position players whose hitting prowess and career achievements in Major League Baseball might surpass Corbin Carroll's are Ichiro Suzuki and Shohei Ohtani.

Compared to Lars Nootbaar and Tommy Edman, the foreign-born players recruited by Japan and South Korea this year, Corbin Carroll has the potential to surpass both of them in the future.

Japanese media have described the situation as follows: "If Team Chinese Taipei can recruit the two players of Taiwanese descent, Corbin Carroll and Stuart Fairchild, for the Classic, it would drastically alter the balance of power in Asian baseball."

Conclusion

Beyond his exceptional skills, what ability does Corbin Carroll possess that players on the Chinese Taipei team lack?

Let's take a look at a few CPBL players who might be selected for the next World Baseball Classic (2026). The table below lists their performance statistics for this season and their ages at the time of the upcoming tournament: (Note: Statistics are current as of the conclusion of games on July 27. This list excludes Tzu-Wei Lin, who returned to Taiwan to play in the CPBL mid-season this year.)

Player	Age	AVG	HR	OPS	K%	BB%	SB	CS	GB/FB
Chih-Chieh Su	32	0.313	9	0.893	13.62%	11.83%	5	3	0.778
Tzu-Hsien Chan	32	0.331	5	0.89	14.95%	14.49%	7	0	0.819
Chieh-Hsien Chen	32	0.308	3	0.824	9.19%	14.13%	3	4	1.41
An-Ko Lin	29	0.275	13	0.922	23.12%	12.5%	1	0	0.5
Kuo-Chen Fan	32	0.258	7	0.715	18.25%	8.76%	4	1	0.679
Kun-Yu Chiang	26	0.285	1	0.715	12.96%	7.78%	2	2	0.933
Wei-Chen Wang	35	0.274	1	0.618	9.1%	4.33%	6	3	1.456
Giljegiljaw Kungkuan	32	0.238	9	0.731	19.92%	9.58%	0	1	0.597

Conclusion

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Combining Power & Speed

Even in the Major Leagues, players like this are rare. There is no doubt that such a player can do anything for the team.

Stolen Base Success Rate

His stolen base success rate of 89.66% this season demonstrates not only great speed but also the ability to read the game situation, making him an even more formidable threat on the basepaths.

Conclusion

Does adding Corbin Carroll guarantee WBC wins? Not necessarily, here are a few examples:

Even with Shohei Ohtani and Mike Trout, two of the best players on the planet, the MLB's Angels still fail to make the playoffs.

Tommy Edman, the St. Louis Cardinals' starting second baseman playing for South Korea in this World Baseball Classic, performed poorly (batting .182 with zero home runs).

Team Chinese Taipei national team player Teng Kai-wei threw only seven pitches, loading the bases, before leaving the game during this World Baseball Classic, but he was promoted to Triple-A during the season.

While recruiting a high-profile foreign player is certainly a plus, factors such as the team's fundamental makeup, the player's current form, which is crucial in short-term tournaments, their ability to integrate into the squad, and their capacity to handle pressure are far more important than their star status.

Conclusion & Remarks

Regardless of how a player's development ultimately unfolds, what matters most to us fans is that they stay healthy and continue to bring us great games, fueled by hard work and fighting spirit.

As a fan from Taiwan, I naturally also hope that this MLB star will have the opportunity in the future to wear the Chinese Taipei jersey and represent the team in the World Baseball Classic!

Thank You!